Kenya

Security Advice

BASIC TRAVEL TIPS – what you should do every time you travel

- Don't stand out: dress inconspicuously and avoid displaying jewellery or valuables such as laptop computers or cameras.
- Do not carry large sums of cash.
- Familiarise yourself with your destination - the layout of the city and important routes – and be vigilant.
- Always carry a charged phone programmed with useful numbers - your hotel, local colleagues, police, or embassy - and the International SOS Assistance app.
- When out and about, keep a safe distance from large, unpredictable crowds – demonstrations or political rallies - and avoid commotions on the street.
- Don't give out personal information and don't discuss your plans with strangers.
- Memorise useful local phrases (please, thank you, yes, no, how much, stop here etc).
- Don't drink to excess: it is likely to reduce your level of awareness and judgment.
- Do not accept food or drinks from strangers: keep your food and drink in sight when socialising.

ADDITIONAL STEPS – what you should do in more complex destinations

- Vary your routine: don't use the same routes at the same time every day.
- If walking in the street, walk against the flow of traffic and carry bags or cases away from the traffic.
- Ignore verbal ‘bait' on the street and avoid eye contact with strangers.
- Do not travel with sensitive information: store data in shared network drives or a cloud, to be retrieved at your destination.
- Carry cash in more than one pocket, and keep a small amount in a top pocket to hand over to a criminal who confronts you. A dummy wallet – with a small amount of local currency, an expired credit card and some useless receipts – can be useful to satisfy a mugger.
- If walking in public, carry small denominations of currency and keep the bulk of cash and cards in a money belt, which should only be accessed in private places.
- If you suspect that you are being followed, enter any busy public place and call for help.

TIPS FOR USING SHARING ECONOMY SERVICES

- Check your company policy allows the use of sharing economy transport and accommodation services.
- Confirm the services are legal at your destination.
- Use ‘for business' versions of the services.
- Do not use ‘pool' car services or ride share.
- Book a self-contained property rather than a room in a shared property.
- **Safe use of sharing economy services varies significantly according to your profile and destination**: if in doubt, or for profile-specific advice, contact our Assistance Centres.

ADDITIONAL TIPS FOR WOMEN TRAVELLERS - Female travellers face additional risks in some destinations

- Observe and respect local clothing customs. Dress modestly to avoid drawing attention.
- In some countries, a lone female traveller is a source of curiosity: you may be stared at if travelling alone. As a precaution, avoid eye contact with strangers, especially on the street and on public transport.
- A wedding ring – even a fake one – can reduce levels of unwanted male attention.
- Decline politely but firmly any invitations which make you feel uncomfortable, even if faced by amicable pressure to accept.
- Ignore suggestive comments.
- A door wedge and/or portable alarm are useful items for extra security in some destinations.
- In some destinations, women-only floors are available and provide additional reassurance; ask about them when you book your room.
- If travelling alone, restrict evening entertainment to business-class hotels or membership clubs.
- Check the transport options at your destination.
- Check additional precautions advised for women travellers: call for advice if you have any concerns about the risks you might face in a given destination.

ADDITIONAL ADVICE FOR LGBT TRAVELLERS

Homosexuality is illegal in many countries. Additionally, social attitudes in many countries can result in harassment of lesbian, gay, bisexual and transgender (LGBT) groups; harassment is also frequently reported in countries where same-sex relationships are legal.

The following steps can be taken to minimise the likelihood of encountering social, legal or physical consequences arising from your sexual orientation:

- Keep a low profile: LGBT travellers generally face harassment or legal censure only if they draw attention to their sexuality. In higher risk locations, LGBT travellers should avoid drawing attention to themselves through public displays of affection or expressing opinions on LGBT issues in public. If LGBT employees receive unusual attention or are victims of abuse, they should leave the area and go back to their hotel or office.
- Follow the law: Travellers should always comply with local laws, including in countries where LGBT activity is illegal.
- Be vigilant: LGBT travellers should exercise higher levels of vigilance in areas with a higher likelihood of physical assault. They should remain alert to their surroundings and check for signs of being followed.

Americas

Homosexuality is legal in most countries of the region, though violent verbal or physical attacks on LGBT individuals occur in some Central and South American nations, and it is best to avoid public displays of affection as a security precaution.

Homosexuality is illegal in some Caribbean nations, including Jamaica and Trinidad and Tobago; verbal and physical attacks on LGBT individuals occur regularly.

Africa

Homosexuality is illegal in the following countries: Mauritania, Nigeria, Somalia and Sudan; punishment can include the death penalty. Harassment of LGBT individuals is common.

Homosexuality is also illegal, and imprisonment and some harassment of LGBT individuals may be experienced, in the following countries: Algeria, Angola, Botswana, Burundi, Cameroon, Comoros, Egypt, Eritrea, Ethiopia, the Gambia, Ghana, Guinea, Kenya, Liberia, Libya, Malawi, Morocco, Namibia, Senegal, Seychelles, Sierra Leone, South Sudan, Swaziland, Tanzania, Togo, Tunisia, Uganda, Zambia and Zimbabwe.

Asia

Homosexuality is illegal in Afghanistan, Bangladesh, Bhutan, Brunei, India, Kiribati, Malaysia, the Maldives, Myanmar, Nauru, Pakistan, Papua New Guinea, Samoa, Singapore, Solomon Islands, Sri Lanka, Tonga, and parts of Indonesia.

In Afghanistan, homosexuality is punishable by death. In Brunei, Pakistan, Malaysia, and the Maldives an LGBT individual could face Sharia law punishments such as whipping, imprisonment, or death by stoning; more commonly, punishment involves fines and jail.

In Bangladesh, Bhutan, India, Kiribati, Myanmar, Nauru, Papua New Guinea, Samoa, Singapore, Solomon Islands, Sri Lanka and Tonga homosexuality is punishable by fines and extended imprisonment.

Laws against homosexuality are only sporadically enforced in Bangladesh, Bhutan, India, Kiribati, Myanmar, Nauru, Papua New Guinea, Samoa, Singapore, Sri Lanka, and Tonga. However LGBT individuals are vulnerable to police harassment.

Homosexuality is legal in most parts of Indonesia. Laws against homosexuality in Aceh and South Sumatra provinces apply to Muslims, but not non-Muslims.

Europe

Homosexuality is legal in most countries of the area. Homosexuality is legal in Russia but there are laws against its expression, including fines for people giving information about homosexuality to minors. In the Balkans, there were several instances of attacks during events organised by the LGBT community (e.g. annual gay pride marches). Violent verbal or physical attacks on LGBT individuals occur in the region and it is best to avoid public displays of affection as a security precaution.

Central Asia

Male homosexuality is illegal in Turkmenistan and Uzbekistan, where the sentence can be up to two and three years imprisonment respectively.

Middle East

Homosexuality is illegal in most countries. Homosexuality is punishable by death in Iran, Saudi Arabia and Sudan, and could be punished by prison sentences, deportation or other significant punitive measures in many other countries. Same-sex relationships are legal in Israel and Jordan, though harassment can occur in both countries.

Risk Ratings

H HIGH MEDICAL RISK for Kenya
M MEDIUM TRAVEL RISK for Kenya
H HIGH TRAVEL RISK for The Somali-border counties of Wajir, Mandera, Garissa and Lamu; the capital Nairobi; Mombasa; the northern counties of Turkana, West Pokot, Samburu, Marsabit and Isiolo

Risk Summary

The greatest risks to travellers in Kenya are from road safety, crime and terrorism. Violent and petty crime poses the most significant security risk to travellers in urban centres, especially the capital Nairobi, where local police protection is inadequate. The risk of unrest tends to be heightened during national political events, including elections and referendums. Potential security threats stem from spontaneous or orchestrated protests and rioting, heavy-handed security crackdowns, vigilante roadblocks and a possible increase in opportunistic crime on the back of political unrest. While business travellers are unlikely to be deliberately targeted, they risk incidental exposure to violence.

Political developments relating to the status of Islam in Kenyan society have the potential to trigger communal unrest. Al-Shabab, the Somalia-based Islamist terrorist group which is suspected to have a large number of supporters in the east of the country and the largely ethnic-Somali areas of Nairobi and Mombasa (Mombasa county), has threatened attacks against Kenya. In September 2013, the group claimed responsibility for a high-profile raid on the Westgate shopping centre in Nairobi. Up until the Westgate incident, militant attacks in the country had been low-impact andpredominantly occurred in towns of counties bordering Somalia or in the lower-income areas of Mombasa and Nairobi. However, in spite of the close co-operation with international anti-terrorism efforts, there are concerns about the capacity of the security forces to deal with the terrorist threat, and there remains a credible potential for another high-profile attack.

This information is intended as a summary of the travel security environment; however, the risks can change at short notice during a crisis or evolving situation. Please check our travel security alerts to ensure you are informed of the most recent developments.

STANDING TRAVEL ADVICE

Alerts

T Meru, Isiolo counties: Fatal cattle rustling clashes highlight need for enhanced security measures for travel to remote northern regions

M Cholera outbreak

M Visceral leishmaniasis outbreak

View All Alerts

Vaccinations For Kenya

Cholera	Oral vaccination is recommended for travellers Read more
Hepatitis A	Recommended for all travellers and expatriates, Read more
Hepatitis B	Recommended for all travellers and expatriates. Read more
Meningitis - meningococcal	Vaccination with the quadrivalent vaccine Read more
Polio	A booster is recommended. Although polio has not Read more
Rabies	Consider for certain travellers, especially: For Read more
Typhoid fever	Recommended for adventurous and long-term Read more
Yellow fever	Kenya is a country with a risk of yellow fever Read more

Routine Vaccinations

- All routine vaccinations should be current: these include Measles-Mumps-Rubella, Polio, Tetanus-Diphtheria-Pertussis, and Varicella.
- Influenza occurs in the northern and southern hemisphere winters and year-round in the tropics. Consider an annual vaccination.

Other Medical Precautions

- Before you go - See your doctor and dentist and ensure you are in the best health before you leave. Other preparations:
- Malaria
- Health Threats

Summary

TRAVEL RISK SUMMARY

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STANDING TRAVEL ADVICE

Kenya (MEDIUM)

- Travel to MEDIUM risk areas of Kenya can continue with standard security precautions.
- Respect local customs and legislation.

Nairobi & Mombasa (HIGH)

- Travel to Nairobi and Mombasa requires enhanced security precautions.
- Avoid non-essential travel to low-income urban areas due to the prevailing risks posed by high levels of violent crime, terrorism and periodic outbreaks of communal violence. If essential, travel should be carried out in daylight hours only and in close co-operation with trusted local partners.
- Travellers should contact the Assistance Centre for itinerary-specific pre-travel advice, including for advice on accommodation options.
- Avoid overt displays of wealth and maintain a good situational awareness.
- Even in more affluent areas, minimise travel on foot.
- Arms ownership is common. In the event of being accosted, assume that your assailant is armed; do nothing to resist or antagonise the attacker.
- Use a trusted local driver for road travel. Do not self-drive unless very familiar with local conditions and avoid travel after dark. All journeys should be conducted in a locked vehicle with the windows rolled up.Do not use buses or minibuses (City Hoppa, KBS or matatus), motorcycle taxis (boda-bodas), unregistered taxis or other forms of public transport.
- Remain abreast of information on volatile gatherings and avoid them due to the credible risk of indiscriminate violence or clashes between protesters and the security forces; do not stop to watch or photograph them.
- Exercise increased vigilance and minimise time spent in the vicinity of potential terrorist targets such as government buildings, diplomatic missions, public transport infrastructure and 'soft' civilian targets.
- When visiting public areas, including shopping centres or hotels, minimise time spent in foyers, lobbies or other parts of the building that are accessible to the public. If you detect unusual behaviour or suspect packages, leave the area immediately and notify the nearest member of the security forces.

Northern Kenya (the counties of Turkana, West Pokot, Samburu, Marsabit and Isiolo) (HIGH)

- Travel to northern Kenya requires enhanced security precautions
- Contact the nearest Assistance Centre for itinerary-specific advice.
- Members should travel to and within these counties by air where it is possible to do so. If road journeys are unavoidable, only conduct movements during daylight hours under strict journey management procedures, and with a trusted guide. Vehicles should be equipped with reliable communications, extra fuel, spare tyres and plenty of water.
- In the event of disturbances or warnings of communal violence, travellers should leave the affected area and immediately move to secure accommodation where they should remain until the situation has stabilised.
- Emergency response capabilities are severely restricted in these areas; members should have security support and contingency plans for a range of scenarios.

Counties bordering Somalia (Mandera, Wajir, Garissa and Lamu) (HIGH)

- Avoid non-essential travel to counties bordering Somalia due to the credible risk of militancy, inter-communal violence, crime and kidnapping.
- Essential travel is possible, but requires enhanced security precautions, including a specific pre-travel threat assessment, security support and in certain cases, a government security escort.
- Overland travel should be avoided where possible; members should travel by air as far as it is possible to do so. Vehicle convoys should be conducted with security support and with a reasonable distance between vehicles, particularly if supported by a government security escort.
- Be aware of your surroundings, particularly on isolated roads or nearby to members of the security forces. Report any suspicious activity or unnatural ground disturbance to the authorities or convoy leader.
- Members conducting essential travel should consider taking hostile environment training, so it is easier to identify and manage threats while travelling in the area.
- Be prepared to respond in the event of an attack; seek immediate cover and only move if in immediate danger, and be sure to head away from the point of attack. Once in a safe area, stand fast and immediately inform someone (either project coordinator, security support or a member of the security forces) of your location and wait for assistance.
- Anticipate stringent security measures due to the high occurrence of militant and bandit attacks; carry relevant identification documents at all times to ease passage through any security checkpoints.

RISK ZONES

Nairobi: HIGH

Crime rates are high and regularly affect foreign travellers and expatriate residents. Attacks can occur anywhere, including in the affluent areas of Gigiri and Westlands, but the risk is highest in and around low-income communities or isolated areas located away from police posts, especially after dark. The city has multiple locations that could, and have, served as attractive targets for attack by Islamist militants; further attempted attacks are anticipated. Political tensions sometime degenerate into violence; while foreigners are unlikely to be targeted, they face an incidental risk and are thus advised to avoid rallies and political gatherings.

Mombasa: HIGH

High levels of anti-government sentiment and heightened religious tensions contribute to an increased likelihood of social unrest and separatist or militant attacks. In addition, the risks in the city are shaped by consistently high levels of crime, much of which is violent, and its geography, where the dense low-income and higher risk areas are in central parts of Mombasa and surrounding the major arterial routes.

Northern Kenya (the counties of Turkana, West Pokot, Samburu, Marasabit, Isiolo): HIGH

Cattle rustling, tribal or clan rivalry, ethnic conflict and armed banditry pose significant risks in rural areas. While foreigners are not usually the targets of local conflicts in rural northern Kenya, they should exercise particular caution in such regions, and seek up-to-date security advice from local contacts before travel. Furthermore, travelling in convoy provides additional back-up.

Counties bordering Somalia (Mandera, Wajir, Garissa and Lamu): HIGH

These counties remain vulnerable to Islamist militancy, inter-communal violence and high levels of societal violence or criminality, including kidnappings. The al-Shabab militant group is known to be active in the area and stages low-level militant attacks – including improvised explosive device (IED) attacks, roadside ambushes and abductions – on a recurrent basis. More often than not attacks target the security forces or the local population, specifically Christian communities, though foreigners would present themselves as attractive targets if the opportunity arose. The Kenya-Somalia border area is prone to high risk activities by the al-Shabab and its offshoot Jaysh Ayman, due to their presence in the Boni Forest, where the terrorist elements established their permanent campground in July 2015.

Personal Risk

CRIME

Crime poses a serious risk to business travellers. The major cities of Nairobi and Mombasa account for almost half of reported crimes in the country and the prevalence of incidents contributes to the HIGH travel risks associated with these cities. However, Kenya's provincial cities and towns still have high rates of crime compared with other urban centres in East Africa. Crime is particularly common in low-income urban areas. Affluent residential communities are often targeted in more sophisticated criminal attacks. Criminals are highly likely to be armed and victims should therefore never resist or antagonise their attacker.

The most common crimes affecting travellers include:

Street crime/opportunistic theft

Opportunistic 'snatch and grab' thefts and street muggings are the most commonly reported crimes and are prevalent in major cities and at beach resorts. Travellers should carry small amounts of cash, and be discrete when handling cash or using smart phones. Laptops should be carried in a non-descript bag that cannot be easily identified. Other valuables, such as watches and jewellery should be left in a secure location or concealed. It is preferable to carry a photocopy of the identification page of the passport, rather than the original document. Travel should not be conducted on foot after dark, especially at public parks and beaches.

Criminals have been known to masquerade as hotel employees or police officers, and sometimes stop foreigners for 'identity checks' before extracting money. Visitors should confirm the identity of hotel staff and all government officials, particularly if they are approached by individuals making such requests or claims.

ATM crime is an increasing concern and muggings at cash machines occur frequently. Card skimming is also regularly reported; criminals attach a fake card reader on top of ATMs to record users' card details. Other tactics include the use of closed-circuit television (CCTV) cameras to view the PIN number before stealing the victim's card and withdrawing cash from the account. Travellers should remain alert when making ATM withdrawals and ensure the machine has not been tampered with. Criminals have been known to damage ATMs in secure locations to force visitors to use ATMs situated in more vulnerable locations. Cash withdrawals should be undertaken in secure areas, such as in shopping malls, hotels or banks, and during daylight hours.

Armed robbery

Orchestrated raids on fuel stations, businesses and shopping facilities, particularly supermarkets and hardware stores, occur frequently in urban areas. Major cities such as Nairobi and Mombasa experience some of the highest rates. Such crimes are normally conducted by organised city gangs. The potential for excessive violence increases if victims resist. If caught in the vicinity of an armed robbery and not directly targeted, members should seek cover and avoid drawing attention to themselves. If approached by the attacker directly – co-operate fully and immediately offer something of financial value, including petty cash or a ‘muggers' wallet made up of small cash, receipts and old credit cards.

Vehicle theft/carjacking

Carjacking continues to be one of the most commonly reported violent crimes. Many such attacks are conducted against local nationals, particularly public transport operators or taxi drivers. Perpetrators are also known to target foreign drivers at the gates of residences, traffic lights, fuel stations, junctions and in slow moving traffic. Drivers should exercise situational awareness, particularly at night, and always leave room to manoeuvre in the event of being accosted, for instance in traffic jams. Drivers should roll up their car windows and lock their doors while driving in urban areas.

In the event of an attack, perpetrators could order occupants out of the vehicle, though there have been cases where the victim has been tied up or locked in the boot of the vehicle and later released in a remote or rural area. It is not uncommon for carjackings to result in fatalities and travellers should never provoke violence by resisting an attack. Travellers should always seek to comply with instructions from attackers, and if possible, get out of the vehicle and immediately move to the nearest secure location.

Residential break-ins

Residential burglaries are usually carried out by armed criminal gangs and commonly target higher-income areas of Nairobi (Westlands, Loresho, Gigiri, Lavington, Karen and Hardy neighbourhoods) and Mombasa (Nyali and Kizingo). Spikes in residential break-ins tend to occur during the peak holiday period beginning in late November and ending in early January.

To mitigate such risks, residents should ensure that their accommodation is fitted with robust security features, including perimeter fencing, an automated gate, burglar bars on windows, and a subscription to a residential security systems company, including an alarm system and armed response service. Residents should seek accommodation in upmarket suburbs located away from major roads and should enquire about crime rates in the area in advance.

Banditry/rural crime

Banditry can occur in most areas of the country, but the risks are generally considered to be highest in the coastal counties of Tana River, Kilifi and Baringo; West Pokot, Noth Samburu and Turkana to the west; Marasabit and Isiolo to the north; and Garissa, Mandera and Wajir to the east. Game parks and reserves, particularly the North of Samburu, Leshaba and Masai Mara game reserves, periodically experience banditry. Criminals in rural areas operate in larger groups than those in urban localities; their activities tend to be more opportunistic, less organised and more prone to violence. Attacks by bandits (known as shifta) are a risk in more remote and sparsely populated areas along the northern and north-eastern borders, which travellers are unlikely to have reason to visit. Travellers going to Lamu Island should travel there by air from Nairobi, Mombasa or Malindi; the flight arrives on the neighbouring island of Manda from where visitors transfer to Lamu by boat.

TERRORISM

There is a credible risk of terrorist attacks in Kenya, given the country's porous borders with Somalia. The risk is exacerbated by evidence suggesting that Islamist militant cells and affiliated sympathisers operate within the country, and Somalia-based militants' clear motive to strike the country given Kenya's troop contributions to the the African Union Mission in Somalia (AMISOM), the international force confronting Islamist extremists in Somalia.

Al-Shabab still poses the most serious Islamist extremist threat in Kenya, though the Islamist extremist group Islamic State (IS) in 2016 asserted its presence in the country. Security guards at the US embassy in October 2016 fatally shot an assailant after he stabbed a General Service Unit (GSU) officer guarding one of the entrances. IS subsequently claimed that a supporter of the group was responsible for the attack. The group also claimed responsibility for an attack in September 2016 in Mombasa in which three women – the attackers – were killed. There have also been sporadic reports regarding arrests of IS sympathisers in Kenya in 2016.

While there has been an improvement in the standard of security, particularly at airports and embassies, it is far from the level seen in the West or the parts of the Middle East. Nevertheless, the increased security at embassies and other high-profile targets likely ensures that militants will focus on 'soft' targets, including hotels, shopping centres, restaurants, bars and other public venues, in major urban centres such as Nairobi and Mombasa. The government has also co-operated closely with international counter-terrorism efforts, including controversial practices such as ‘extraordinary renditions' of Kenyan citizens. Grievances relating to perceived religious and political marginalisation within the Somali diaspora – and Kenya's Muslim population in general – help sustain domestic militant recruitment in the country.

High-profile terrorist attacks

The country is an attractive target for transnational militant groups. The worst terrorist incident in Kenyan history occurred in 1998, when a car-bomb attack on the US embassy in Nairobi killed 213 people. More recently, on 2 April 2015, the Somalia-based Islamist al-Shabab militant group claimed an attack against Garissa University College in Garissa (Garissa county), in which at least 152 people were killed and dozens others were injured. On 21 September 2013, al-Shabab claimed responsibility for an armed raid at the Westgate shopping centre in Nairobi. More than 65 people were killed and 170 others injured in the attack; several were taken hostage.

High-profile attacks are irregular and this is likely to remain the case; such plots require skilled operators, greater planning and wider involvement, ensuring there is a greater opportunity for detection. Furthermore, the alertness of international and domestic security agencies has improved since the Westgate siege, which also prompted significant counter-terrorism assistance from Kenya's international partners. The security forces have since been successful in foiling a number of reported high-profile militant plots but there remains a risk that another high-profile extremist plot will evade the attention of the intelligence services.

Low-level urban attacks

Small-scale explosive attacks were an almost weekly occurrence in the major cities of Nairobi and Mombasa between 2012-13. The attacks generally targeted members of the security forces or residents in low-income neighbourhoods. The frequency of attacks has since reduced and this is likely due to the increased efforts of the security forces to infiltrate militant networks and al-Shabab's new operational focus on the Kenyan north east. Previous hotspots for low-level attacks included low-income neighbourhoods or districts, such as of South C, Dandora, Eastleigh, and the industrial district in Nairobi - home to the Somali diaspora - and Kisauni and Likoni in Mombasa – a major political base for Kenyan Muslims and separatist movements.

Counties bordering Somalia

Since 2013 there has been a pattern of intensified attacks in counties bordering Somalia. Such incidents typically entail low-level grenade or gun attacks against government infrastructure, transport hubs, bars, churches, Christian communities and other public areas. It is thought that in the wake of the Westgate terror attacks, al-Shabab changed its message to exploit long-standing local grievances related to land, resources, devolution and religion in the north eastern counties in an attempt to increase the legitimacy of the group in the eyes of the local population, aid recruitment from local communities and sow divisions between Muslim and Christian communities. The group is now expected to have several off-shoots, including the al-Hijra group and the Jeysh Ayman brigade, permanently operating as roaming insurgent groups in Kenyan territory. Indeed in July 2015, it was reported that al-Shabab militants had established a permanent base camp deep inside the Boni Forest (Garissa and Lamu counties), which prompted major security force operations in the area in the following months. The Somali border region is likely to remain highly vulnerable to militant activity with the potential for longer term deterioration.

KIDNAPPING

Foreign nationals are vulnerable to kidnap-for-ransom in the north-eastern, border and coastal areas close to conflict-torn Somalia. Militant and criminal groups, who benefit from the general lawlessness in southern Somalia, frequently stage incursions across its porous border. A spate of abductions in the latter half of 2011 was a determining factor behind the military intervention into Somalia in October of that year. More recently, four foreign aid workers in June 2012 were abducted from the Dadaab refugee camp in Garissa county.

In Nairobi, the security forces' clamp down on kidnapping gangs has reduced the number of attacks on foreign nationals since 2009. Nevertheless, kidnappings of wealthy locals are frequently reported. Expatriates, whose daily routines are often predictable, are more vulnerable to kidnap-for-ransom than travellers on short duration visits.

SOCIAL UNREST

Communal violence

Prolonged clashes over cattle rustling, as well as tribal and political rivalries, occur frequently in the counties of Turkana, West Pokot, Samburu, Isiolo, Mandera, Tana River and the northernmost areas of Marasabit. Cross-border clashes at the Ethiopian frontier in the region of the Ilemi Triangle over historic clan rivalries can also lead to cycles of violence between rival communities.

Most incidents are confined to remote rural communities and the majority of foreign visitors are highly unlikely to be affected. Nevertheless, travellers embedded with communities vulnerable to bouts of communal disturbances could be exposed to indiscriminate violence and credible incidental risks.

There have been a number of low-level attacks targeting remote location exploration camps within the north Turkana region. Reporting has stated that this is due to perceptions of marginalisation among the local population in regards to remuneration from the oil companies operating in Kenya.

Political/socio-economic unrest

Protests by students, street vendors, public transport operators and local communities over socio-economic grievances or security issues are fairly common and are likely to involve unruly elements, potentially entailing rioting, looting and arson. The police are liable to use forceful measures such as tear gas, batons and live ammunition to disperse any unruly demonstrations. Walkouts by professional workers are generally peaceful.

Local disputes relating to tribal and political issues can occasionally cause violent bouts of unrest. Politically motivated violence has previously erupted during election periods, and indirectly impacted foreign travel and business continuity nationwide. Political violence can be self-perpetuating, with localised incidents triggering outbreaks of unrest and targeted violence in other areas that were not initially affected.

BUSINESSWOMEN

While Eastern Africa has a high incidence of sexual assault and rapes, the majority of cases are either domestic or occur in low-income communities, where women face additional vulnerabilities. Nonetheless, female travellers should be alert to the increased risks and adopt sensible security precautions as a routine measure.

- The majority of attacks on lone female travellers occur at night in dark streets, beach areas, unauthorised taxis or in the vicinity of nightlife areas. Remain vigilant in such areas and book taxis through the hotel or a trusted local third party.
- Female travellers are advised to prioritise security concerns when selecting accommodation. Lone females relocating for the medium-to-long term should reside in a secure complex where possible.
- Adopt sensible pedestrian security measures; avoid walking unattended in isolated areas and desist from walking outside of secure locations after dark. When walking, be aware of your surroundings and occasionally check for any signs that you are being followed.
- Avoid giving away personal information to unfamiliar people, including full name, contact details and any address where you might be staying, visiting or working.
- Be particularly alert in restaurants, bars and nightclubs. Never leave a drink unattended or accept drinks from strangers. Some common effects of date rape drugs include dizziness, drowsiness, memory loss – which can be transient or long lasting depending on the drug –, nausea, vomiting, confusion and impaired muscle control. Travellers who suspect they may have been victim of a date rape attack should seek professional medical advice and support immediately.
- For further tips consult the ‘Additional Advice for Women' section of our General Security Advice in our travel security pages.

CONFLICT

Kenya's border area with Somalia continues to suffer from insecurity as a result of the country's continued involvement in the African Union Mission in Somalia (AMISOM), which is fighting the Islamist extremist al-Shabab militant group. The Kenyan army's involvement means that the country remains an attractive target for reprisal militant attacks. Refer to our Terrorism section for more information.

Relations with Uganda improved slightly following the establishment of the East African Community (EAC). Although the two countries are engaged in a dispute over the sovereignty of Migingo Island in Lake Victoria, stemming mostly from demands for fishing rights, though this is unlikely to lead to open conflict. Low-level tensions also exist with Ethiopia over insecure border regions.

EMERGENCY NUMBERS

Emergency Numbers	
Fire	999
Police	999

Ambulance services are not recommended. Contact **International SOS** for help with your medical situation.

Country Stability

POLITICAL SITUATION

Kenya is a parliamentary democracy with a unicameral National Assembly. Both the president and the assembly serve a five-year term.

Kenya has a history for being one of the most politically stable countries in East Africa, though that reputation was shattered during the 2007 national election. On 30 December that year, incumbent president Mwai Kibaki of the Party of National Unity (PNU) was declared winner against Raila Odinga of the Orange Democratic Movement (ODM). Allegations of electoral irregularities sparked widespread ethno-political attacks, predominantly by the Kalenjin and Luo communities against the Kikuyu. An estimated 1,500 people were killed over a two-month period, while more than 500,000 people were internally displaced. The security situation normalised following international intervention and the subsequent creation of an inclusive Government of National Unity (GNU) in April 2008.

There were concerns that the March 2013 elections, due to their tightly contested nature, could similarly be marred by political violence. However, an alliance between Uhuru Kenyatta, a Kikuyu, and William Ruto, who drew support from the Kalenjin community, did much to allay simmering ethnic tensions. Polling was largely peaceful and Kenyatta narrowly defeated Odinga's Coalition for Reform and Democracy (CORD), and sealed the presidency by a mere 4,000 votes. After initially contesting the result, Odinga conceded defeat after the courts rejected his appeal. The election cycle thus passed off without a repeat of the 2007-08 violence, though tensions between ethnic groups persist and could reignite given an appropriate trigger. Political stability was once again brought into question in April 2016, when CORD accused the Independent Electoral and Boundaries Commission (IEBC) of partisanship and organised numerous countrywide protests to demand the resignation of allegedly corrupt commissioners.

RULE OF LAW

The Kenyan legal system is based on British common law with added elements of Islamic and customary law. The highest levels of legal authority are the high court and court of appeal; the president appoints the chief justice of the court of appeal. In low-income or rural communities, justice is frequently administered at the local level. A culture for local dispute resolution and perceptions that the government is unable to protect communities from prevalent crime encourage the presence of vigilante groups and mob attacks, which can occasionally entail high levels of violence and frequently result in fatalities. Travellers inadvertently caught in the middle of mob violence should immediately vacate the area and inform a member of the security forces.

The Kenyan Police Service (KPS) is almost solely a reactive force and its performance in deterring and investigating crime is generally poor. The force often lacks the equipment, resources, training and staff to respond effectively to calls for assistance or other emergencies. Police reforms are being implemented but the KPS remains under-resourced. Residents and expatriates generally employ security guards and use radio alarm systems to compensate for inadequate policing.

Police officers are known to commit crimes such as murder and robbery, usually targeting local nationals in low-income areas. The police sometimes erect roadblocks on routes into and out of central Nairobi, residential areas and Jomo Kenyatta International Airport (NBO). The police may not stop a vehicle outside municipal boundaries unless a proper roadblock (which usually includes spikes) or a police vehicle is in evidence. Travellers should exercise caution in all dealings with members of the security forces.

Criminals sometimes pose as police officers. Check for official identification and carefully examine the officer's uniform and vehicle for any unorthodox signs.

CORRUPTION

Corruption is common in government, the civil service, business circles and occurs at all levels, which results in an ineffective legal and justice system. Corruption within the police force is also a major concern. Corrupt officers will identify potential targets that look unfamiliar with the local environment, or who they believe could be intimidated, and threaten them with the inconvenience of going to the nearest police station, or even arrest, in a bid to extort bribes or spurious fines. If confronted by a suspicious demand from an officer, be sure to show, but avoid handing over, all the necessary documentation. Personable behaviour is the best tactic to avoid paying a fine or bribe; follow the lead of the driver and maintain a consistent explanation of why it is not possible to pay the demanded fine. Any amount of time in police custody poses a variety of threats to travellers; visitors facing the credible possibility of police detention should telephone a trusted local contact, or your nearest assistance centre, to inform them of the situation and request immediate assistance.

NATURAL DISASTERS

The country is prone to droughts, especially in the northern and eastern regions of Garissa, Isiolo, Marsabit, Moyale, Turkana and Wajir. Wildfires can also occur during dry spells. Floods occur frequently; coastal settlements, river flood plains and areas around Lake Victoria are particularly vulnerable to flooding during the two rainy seasons (October-November and March- mid-June). Landslides can be a problem in some parts of the country.

RECENT HISTORY

Daniel arap Moi succeeded Kenya's founding president Jomo Kenyatta in 1978. Although he started on a populist note, promising to tackle corruption, limit foreign ownership of industry and review land policies, Moi's rule became increasingly authoritarian, including amendments to the constitution, making Kenya a one-party state. Grievances mounted and prompted widespread protests and riots.

In response to international pressure, Moi initiated constitutional amendments allowing multi-party democracy. In 1992, Moi was re-elected as President in Kenya's first multi-party election in 26 years. There were widespread allegations of rigging and the elections were denounced by opposition parties, who claimed they were fraudulent. Moi was again returned to power during the 1997 elections amidst repeated charges of electoral fraud and escalating corruption.

Moi was forced to surrender the presidency after a protracted tenure of 24 years, in accordance with new constitutional amendments introduced after the election in 2002. The outgoing President gave his support to Uhuru Kenyatta, son of Jomo Kenyatta, for the presidency. However, the elections brought Mwai Kibaki's multi-ethnic National Rainbow Coalition (NARC) to power. Kibaki, who had earlier been Vice President under the KANU government, had been defeated by Moi in the 1992 and 1997 elections.

NARC won a significant majority in parliament and pledged to improve the Kenyan people's quality of life and root out corruption. The new administration duly introduced free primary education, adopted several anti-corruption measures, and initiated a clean-up of the judiciary. However, in the early 2000s, the government came under fire for a perceived lack of success in tackling grassroot issues, such as corruption, poverty and land distribution. Although his popularity began to wane, Kibaki stood for re-election in 2007, under a new alliance dubbed the Party of National Unity (PNU). Opinion polls leading up to the election showed Kibaki well behind the CORD alliance's Raila Odinga. Following a protracted count marred in claims of fraud, Kibaki was declared the winner and hastily sworn in as President. Voting had closely followed ethnic lines, and the pro-Odinga tribes (Kalenjin, Lua, Luo) saw the result as a fraudulent attempt by kibaki's Kikuyu ethnic group to maintain power. Anti-Kikuyu sentiment spread, leading to around two months of widespread ethno-political violence during which around 1,500 people were killed.

Following international mediation, a landmark political agreement was achieved in February 2008, establishing a coalition government with Odinga as Prime Minister. Following the adoption of a new constitution in 2010, the country avoided widespread violence at the following elections in 2013, which were tightly fought between Uhuru Kenyatta's Jubilee Alliance and Odinga's CORD alliance. Kenyatta, who represented the Kikuyu, emerged victorious after securing an alliance with William Ruto, who drew his support from the Kalenjin community from the populated areas of the Rift Valley. Upon assuming office, both Kenyatta and Ruto faced indictment by the International Criminal Court (ICC) for allegedly inciting violence during the 2007/8 crisis; the case against Kenyatta has since collapsed due to insufficient evidence while Ruto's charges were dropped in early 2016. Notwithstanding the ICC issue, the Jubilee Alliance has come under increased pressure to address what is perceived to be a deteriorating security situation with rising rates of corruption and crime. This includes frequent outbreaks of communal violence and, most notably, the threat of Islamist militancy which was brought to the forefront with the high-profile armed siege by Islamist gunmen at Nairobi's Westgate shopping centre in September 2013.

Before You Go

See your doctor and dentist and ensure you are in the best health before you leave. Other preparations:

- Check your routine vaccinations are up to date (polio; varicella; measles, mumps and rubella; tetanus, diphtheria and pertussis). See a travel health practitioner 6 to 8 weeks before departure for destination-specific health preparations. You may need additional vaccinations, some of which require several doses, or be

recommended malaria medication which may need to be started a week or more before arriving in the malarial country.

- **Documentation:** Arrange a copy of your personal health record to carry with you when you travel. Include a letter from your doctor explaining your need for all medications you are carrying, including any over-the-counter medications, in English and the language of your destination(s). Make sure you have copies of your prescriptions.
- **Medication:** Check the regulations of your destination country regarding importation of your medication, as some drugs may be strictly prohibited (especially narcotics and psychotropics) and may result in severe penalties. Take any medicines you require *in their original packaging*, including any information leaflets, with them clearly labelled with your name (matching your passport name), and your doctor's name. Have enough to cover the trip, and extra in case of delays, however note that many destinations limit quantities of certain drugs to a 30-day supply. Carry medication in your hand luggage, with copies of your prescriptions.

Vaccinations for Kenya

Recommendations may vary for short-term visitors. Always consult your travel health advisor or contact International SOS to discuss your specific needs.

Cholera	Oral vaccination is recommended for travellers and relief workers who are likely to encounter unsanitary conditions, or will have limited access to safe water. These are the conditions more commonly associated with cholera outbreaks. Vaccination is not 100% protective, and hygiene, food and water precautions must still be taken.
Hepatitis A	Recommended for all travellers and expatriates, especially: • For long-term or frequent visitors. • For adventurous travellers who travel to more remote locations or stay in areas with poor sanitation. • For men who have sex with men, people who inject drugs or those with liver conditions.
Hepatitis B	Recommended for all travellers and expatriates.
Meningitis - meningococcal	Vaccination with the quadrivalent vaccine (serogroups A, C, Y and W135) is recommended for anyone who is: • Travelling during the dry season (December to June). • Travelling during outbreaks. • At increased risk including: ○ Those visiting friends and relatives. ○ Healthcare workers. ○ Long-term travellers who will have close contact with the local population.
Polio	A booster is recommended. Although polio has not been recorded in this country for some time, there is a risk of polio importation from areas nearby.
Rabies	Consider for certain travellers, especially: • For expatriates and long-term visitors. • For children who tend to play with animals and may not admit to being bitten or scratched. • If you are travelling to a location where quality medical care may not be available immediately after being bitten/scratched by an animal. (Unvaccinated people need immunoglobulin within 24 hours of an animal injury, and this medication is scarce in some countries. If you are pre-vaccinated, you do not need this immunoglobulin after an injury.) • If contact with dogs, monkeys or other potentially rabies-carrying animals is likely. Jogging increases your risk of dog bite.
Typhoid fever	Recommended for adventurous and long-term travellers, especially those who will: • Visit friends and relatives. • Eat from local vendors or restaurants. • Be exposed to conditions of poor sanitation. • Visit smaller cities or rural areas.
Yellow fever	Kenya is a country with a risk of yellow fever transmission. A yellow fever vaccination certificate is ***required*** for entry for anyone > 1 year of age arriving from a country with a risk of yellow fever transmission. Vaccination is *recommended* for all travellers > 9 months of age travelling to Kenya, except vaccination is *generally NOT recommended* for travellers only visiting the following areas; the cities of Nairobi and Mombasa, the entire North Eastern Province, or the states of Kilifi, Kwale, Lamu, Malindi and Tanariver in Coastal province. See the map of vaccination recommendations. *For onward travel:* You may be required to show proof of vaccination upon departure and your next destination, including your home country, may require a vaccination certificate for entry. *(Discuss vaccination with your travel health professional well in advance of your trip. The certificate becomes valid 10 days after vaccination and is valid for the life of the traveller. Note that vaccination requirements may change at any time; check with the relevant embassy or consulate for your destination. Occasionally border authorities request a valid vaccination certificate although it may not be required under the official policy.)*

More on diseases in Kenya

Malaria

Threat from: Insect Bites

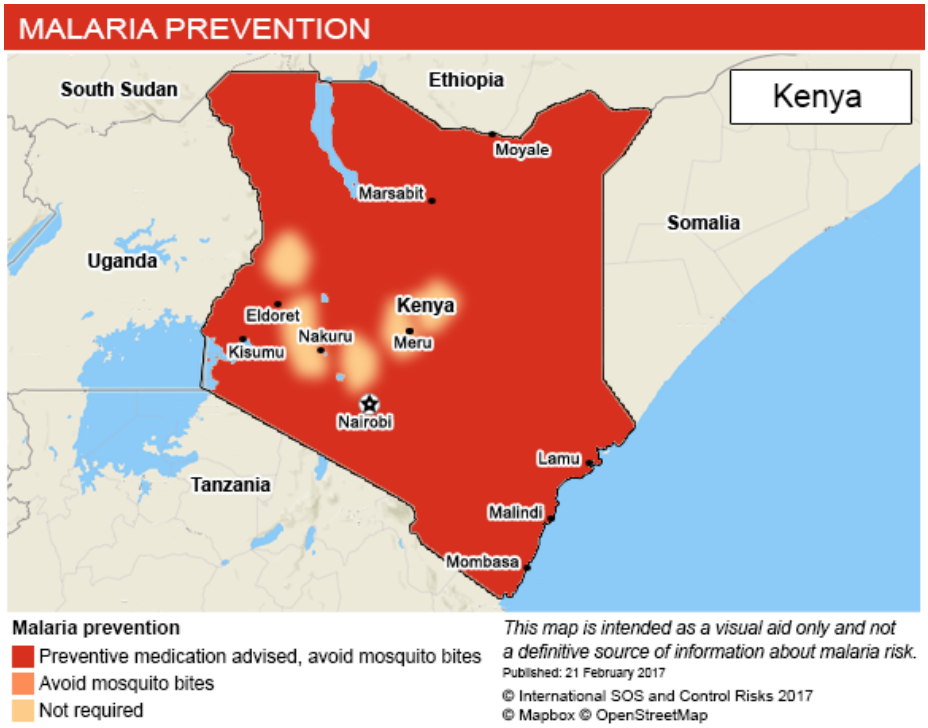
Malaria is present in most of Kenya, including the game parks.
Chloroquine-resistant *P. falciparum* malaria is present.

There is no malaria in:

- Altitudes higher than 2,500 meters (8,202 feet).

There is malaria in:

- All other areas, including the city of Nairobi.



Malaria is transmitted by mosquitoes that usually bite from dusk to dawn. Symptoms can develop as early as six days or as late as several months after exposure. Early malaria symptoms are flu like, such as head/body aches and generally feeling tired and unwell. Untreated, it can cause complications including anaemia, seizures, mental confusion, kidney failure and coma. It can be fatal.

Malaria in this country is resistant to the medication chloroquine.

PREVENTING MALARIA

- **Prevent mosquito bites.**
- **Chemoprophylaxis.**
  If visiting malarial areas, use a medication to prevent chloroquine-resistant *P. falciparum* malaria. These include:
  - Atovaquone plus proguanil (Malarone® and generics)
  - Doxycycline (many brands and generics)
  - Mefloquine (Lariam® and generics)

Continue malarial prophylaxis while exposed to malaria. Stopping the medication while still exposed leaves you susceptible again to the dangerous consequences of malaria.

Standard of Care

Emergency Response

Always try to call International SOS whenever medical care or advice is required, especially in emergencies.

There are a number of small private ambulance services to which International SOS can arrange access. Generally the public ambulance system is not as robust, and can suffer from equipment and / or staffing issues.

Emergency Numbers	
Fire	999
Police	999

Standard of Health Care

Medical standards in Nairobi are the best available in the country, and most specialties are available. Many health professionals are trained in Europe. Most Kenyans speak English. Elsewhere the standard of care is lower, including in Mombasa. Outside the main cities, medical infrastructure can be very limited.

Even in cities, equipment supply, reliability and maintenance can be problematic. More complex medical cases, including those requiring specialized surgery or specialist inpatient care, may be recommended international evacuation, to locations such as Johannesburg.

OutPatient Care

There are many doctors in Nairobi and Mombasa who can provide suitable outpatient care for uncomplicated medical conditions.

Paying for Health Care

Most doctors and medical facilities will require payment by cash or credit card at the time of service.

Do not defer medical treatment because of financial concerns. Contact International SOS, and if our terms allow, we will make financial arrangements on your behalf.

Dental Care

The best dental care in the country is in Nairobi. Complex cases may need international referral, usually to Johannesburg.

Blood Supplies

The blood supplies in a few major reliable hospitals are screened according to international standards. However, there is a high local incidence of HIV and hepatitis. Blood products in the country may be infected despite screening.

Even in areas where the blood supply is considered safe, it's best to avoid blood transfusions if possible. Screening cannot detect every blood-borne disease, and immune reactions can vary from minor to life-threatening. If a blood transfusion is recommended and circumstances permit, seek a second opinion from International SOS or your health advisor.

Medication Availability

In the larger cities, most medications are available from hospitals and pharmacies. These medications are usually of good quality. However, shortages do occur occasionally.

Since brand names vary, know the generic (chemical) names of your medications. It is always advisable to bring an adequate supply of prescription and other medications from your home country. Check the expiration date on all medications.

Clinics & Hospitals

Medical Providers

No matter where you are, contact International SOS first if you are sick, injured or need medical advice.

Our medical staff will advise you, help you select the correct doctor, hospital or clinic, and make any necessary appointments on your behalf. If our terms allow, we will also make financial arrangements for you.

It is recommended that you contact International SOS before accessing medical care in Kenya

Hospitals / Clinics

If you are unable to contact International SOS, the following list of hospitals and clinics is provided in case of medical emergencies.

Mombasa

Aga Khan Hospital Mombasa

Category:	Hospital
Address:	Barack Obama Dr Dar es Salaam Mombasa, n/a 80100
Telephone:	254 (0) 41 222 7710 - 5 254 (0) 41 231 2953

Nairobi

Nairobi Hospital

Category:	Hospital
Address:	Argwings Kodhek Road Nairobi, NA 00100
Telephone:	254 20 284 5000 / 6000 254 70 308 2000 (Main)

The Aga Khan University Hospital

Category:	Hospital
Address:	Parklands 3rd Avenue Nairobi, NA 00100
Telephone:	254 (0)20 366 2000 254 (0)20 374 0000 254 (0)20 374 2531

Food & Water

Food and Water Precautions

Travellers have a small risk of developing diarrhoea in any country. It may be advisable to drink bottled water only, especially on short trips. Always wash your hands with soap before eating, or use an alcohol-based hand sanitizer. See the following country-specific recommendations:

Water and Beverages

Tap water is unsafe throughout Kenya. Nairobi experiences intermittent water shortages. Drink only bottled water and carbonated beverages. Avoid ice.

Food Risk

Food served in large hotels and well-known restaurants should be safe. In coastal areas, fresh seafood should also be safe. Avoid street vendors, because the standard of hygiene may be low and food may not be fresh. Do not buy pre-peeled fruit or salad. Fruit that you wash and peel yourself should be safe. Ensure that milk and other dairy products have been pasteurised.

More on food and water safety

Health Threats

These pages display diseases in approximate order of risk

Malaria | Threat from : Insect Bites

Malaria is transmitted by mosquitoes that usually bite from dusk to dawn. Symptoms can develop as early as six days or as late as several months after exposure. Early malaria symptoms are flu like, such as head/body aches and generally feeling tired and unwell. Untreated, it can cause complications including anaemia, seizures, mental confusion, kidney failure and coma. It can be fatal.

More on Malaria and its presence in Kenya

Yellow fever | Threat from : Insect Bites

Yellow fever is caused by a virus spread through mosquito bites. It only occurs in parts of Africa and South America. The symptoms range from a mild flu-like illness to a severe haemorrhagic fever with organ failure. Yellow fever can be deadly, and there is no treatment. However, it can be prevented via vaccination.

More on Yellow fever and its presence in Kenya

Travelers' diarrhea | Threat from : Food and/or water

Travellers' diarrhoea usually occurs within the first week away from home. It affects between 20 and 50 percent of all international travelers, especially people visiting high-risk destinations such as developing nations in Latin America, Africa, Asia and the Middle East.

More on Travelers' diarrhea

Dengue fever | Threat from : Insect Bites

Dengue, or "break-bone" fever, is a viral disease of the tropics and sub-tropics. It is transmitted by the *Aedes aegypti* mosquito that bites during the daytime and is found in and around human habitation. Symptoms include high fever, severe headaches, joint and muscle pain. A rash often follows. The acute illness can last up to ten days, but complete recovery can take two to four weeks.

More on Dengue fever

Rabies | Threat from : Animals

Rabies is a viral disease contracted when bitten or scratched by an infected (rabid) animal, often a dog. Once it enters the body, the virus travels along nerves and causes paralysis. As it reaches important organs like the spinal cord and the brain, it causes coma and death.

More on Rabies

More diseases associated with Kenya
1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5

Getting There

METHOD OF ARRIVAL

By air

Kenya's two main international airports are Jomo Kenyatta (NBO) in Nairobi and Moi International (MBA) in Mombasa. Connecting flights to other destinations in Kenya or northern Tanzania are often made at Nairobi's smaller Wilson Airport (WIL).

Travellers should arrange to be met at Nairobi airport for transfers to Wilson airport. Theft of and from luggage remains a sporadic problem; travellers should be vigilant with their personal belongings. All valuables should be carried in hand luggage, while suitcases put in the aircraft hold should be visibly locked to minimise the risk of theft. A baggage wrap service can also be used at Nairobi airport in order to provide additional protection. Procedures and security checks at the airport can be tedious. Despite an increase in security and previous international initiatives, airport security levels remain below those in more developed countries.

Airlines have variable security standards. You may wish to consult the European Commission's website for a list of airlines banned within the EU and the US Federal Aviation Administration's website for a database of aviation accidents and statistics.

By land

Travellers journeying overland from Uganda or Tanzania are unlikely to face any major problems or delays at border crossings. Border crossings with Uganda are located at Malaba and Busia, while Moyale serves as a border crossing with Ethiopia; Arusha is a border crossing with Tanzania. However, while driving, travellers should observe safety precautions. They also need to have valid insurance documents and logbooks. There is also a bus service between Kampala (Uganda) and the capital Nairobi, as well as a train link from Mombasa via Nairobi to Kampala. Travel along the borders with Somalia and Ethiopia is not recommended due to the significant risks posed by banditry, carjacking and cross-border violence. Instead, passengers should travel by air. If road travel is unavoidable, travellers should only travel during daylight hours and with a local guide and/or security support.

By sea

The Port of Mombasa is the main sea port that receives international ships and cruise liners.

Entry & Departure Requirements

Passport and visa requirements are subject to change and vary depending on the length of stay and visa type (business or tourist). Check with your travel advisor, embassy or consulate in your home country. Passports must be valid for at least six months from the date of entry.

	Passport Required?	Visa Required?	Return Ticket Required
Australia	Yes	Yes	Yes
United Kingdom	Yes	Yes	Yes

Canada	Yes	Yes	Yes
Europe	Yes	Yes	Yes
United States	Yes	Yes	Yes

Visas

Foreign nationals referred to in the chart above require visas.

Nationals mentioned on Kenya's immigration department's website do not need visas to enter the country. Citizens of some countries may require a referred visa (costs $10) which is approved by the Immigration Department in Nairobi. As part of the East African Community (EAC), nationals of Rwanda and Uganda can use a single tourist visa to visit Kenya for 90 days multiple times. The cost of the visa is $100. All others who require a visa can obtain it upon arrival. In July 2015, Kenyan authorities introduced the online visa procedure to replace the visa-on-arrival system. Online visas take up to two days to be processed. Visa stamps upon arrival are still available but will be permanently replaced by the online visa applications in the future.

Single and multiple entry visas cost $50 and $100 respectively and are valid for three months from the date of issue. Visitors are permitted to re-enter Kenya on their existing single-entry visa if they only travel within the East African Community (EAC). Passengers transiting through Kenya require a transit visa which entitles them to stay for 72 hours. Transit visas cost $20. Visa applications take three working days (if applying in person) or one week from date of receipt (postal applications) to process. If the visa has to be referred to Nairobi, it will take up to six weeks or longer. Work permits are required if travellers intend to work in Kenya.

Entry/Exit requirements

All visitors must have a valid passport for six months from the date of entry, with at least two blank pages and proof of sufficient funds for the intended stay and a return/onward ticket. Travellers are issued a visitor's pass on arrival, which is valid for up to three months, while citizens of EAC member states may be issued a visitor's pass for a period of six months. Limits are imposed on the removal of large amounts of foreign currency from the country, though checking and implementation can vary. Travellers carrying the equivalent of US$ 5,000 or more must provide documentation stating the source and purpose of the fund. Export of local currency is limited to 100,000 Kenyan shillings (KSh).

Procedures

Immigration formalities can be tedious and involve long queues and associated delays. Travellers should keep the required cash in the correct denomination for obtaining visas. Bribery requests are not generally a problem and travellers should remain calm and courteous, even if provoked. Travellers should also not take literature of a sensitive political or pornographic nature into the country.

Customs officials occasionally insist that visitors pay a hard currency deposit (returnable on departure) for cameras or electrical equipment in order to control the illegal importation and sale of such goods, though this is rare. A receipt should be obtained if such a deposit is requested.

Departure Tax

- A departure tax of 200 Kenyan shillings (KSh) applies to domestic passengers, while a $40 fee applies to international passengers.

Getting Around

BY AIR

Air travel is the safest, most convenient form of long-distance internal transportation. Kenya Airways, the national flag carrier, operates regular flights to all major destinations in Kenya.

Other domestic carriers include privately owned Air Kenya and Fly540, which operate a network of internal scheduled flights from Nairobi to Mombasa, Malindi, Lamu and Kisumu, as well as to tourist destinations such as game parks. Smaller aircraft embarking on internal flights also depart from Nairobi's Wilson Airport.

Seats should be booked in advance and reconfirmed at least 48 hours before departure, especially for flights to and from Malindi and Kisumu. Light aircraft can be chartered from private airlines.

BY ROAD

Car hire is available but should be avoided unless visitors are familiar with Kenyan roads, have experience of local driving conditions and are aware of the high probability of being targeted by police officers looking for opportunistic and tenuous traffic fines. Traffic drives on the left, though during heavy traffic motorists have been known to cross the median and drive on the wrong side of the road. Driving standards are poor; many drivers are undisciplined, untrained and drive un-roadworthy vehicles. Four-wheel drive (4WD) vehicles are recommended when travelling on other than main roads, though unpaved roads often become impassable during the country's rainy season, even with 4WD vehicles. When hiring vehicles, avoid luxury or overtly attractive models because of the greater risk from carjacking; thieves are known to favour 4WD vehicles. Travellers should be aware that carjacking can occur at any time of the day, even in central urban business districts. Foreign drivers can use their valid national driving licence for up to three months.

Travellers should complete their journeys before dark where possible; driving is particularly hazardous at night, when some vehicles do not use headlights and drivers may be intoxicated, while the streets often lack proper lighting. Potholes also pose a significant risk as they can be large enough to break vehicle axles, leaving occupants stranded in remote or dangerous locations. In addition, the risk of armed robbery is also higher after dark; many drivers in Nairobi ignore traffic lights (known locally as 'robots') to avoid being stationary. Gunmen usually force victims out of their vehicle or abandon them in a remote area, such as Karura forest in Nairobi. The Coast Road between Malindi and Lamu, as well as routes into game parks and Nairobi, have all been targeted for highway robbery and carjacking.

Banditry is a serious problem, especially in the northern and north-eastern areas of the country. Travellers undertaking cross-country travel should do so by air where possible. If unavoidable, then a convoy should be arranged with security support and the journey should be conducted during daylight hours.

The police occasionally erect roadblocks on routes into and out of central Nairobi, residential areas and Jomo Kenyatta airport. Police may charge on-the-spot fines for breaking traffic regulations; however, they are not legal and a ‘receipt for cash bond' should be asked detailing the charges. The police may not stop a vehicle outside municipal boundaries unless a proper roadblock (which usually includes spikes) or a police vehicle is in evidence. Criminals sometimes pose as police officers.

BY TAXI

If using taxis, consult local hosts or your hotel about reputable taxi companies; most normal taxis are of a poor standard and lack seatbelts, while there is also a greater risk of in-vehicle crime, such as mugging or express kidnapping, in such vehicles. Kenatco state-licensed cabs are commonplace outside business hotels, shopping centres and tourist areas. Taxis are not metered and the price should therefore be agreed before departing. Fares are generally determined by distance, though journeys to some locations, such as the airport, will have fixed rates. Taxi drivers tend to be fairly open about journey costs. Where possible, hotel cars can be used.

BY TRAIN

The country's rail network has limited coverage; trains are poorly maintained and services are slow. Business travellers should avoid them as theft is common; valuables from compartments have been stolen.

BY OTHER MEANS

Public transport

The use of public transport is not recommended in Kenya. Luxury tourist buses, which are faster than trains, are unsuitable for business travel as traffic accidents are a concern. Short-distance shared minibuses (*matatus*), which provide a cheap but uncomfortable service, can be dangerous and should be avoided: *matatu* crashes are frequent across the country due to reckless driving, while they have also been targeted for robbery. Motorbike taxis (boda-bodas) should also be avoided for similar safety reasons.

By ferry

Commercial ferries serving the tourist industry are generally a viable mode of transport. Public ferries operate along the eastern coast in Mombasa (Likoni) and Lamu and on the Tana river at Garsen. However, local ferry services are not suitable for travellers and should be avoided for safety reasons.

Language & Money

LANGUAGE

English is the official language and Swahili is the national language. Swahili is used more frequently than English, but the local population often uses a combination of the two, as well as a modern version known as Sheng. English is not widely spoken outside urban centres or other densely populated areas, where a number of different tribal languages are more common, such as Kikuyu, Kalenjin and Maasai.

MONEY

The local currency is the Kenyan shilling (KSh). Major hotels and banks will change money, though many hotel bills must be paid in foreign currency (US dollars are the most accepted). It is advisable to keep foreign currency in relatively new condition, as Kenyan banks may refuse older notes. Exchange receipts must be kept, as Kenyan money cannot otherwise be changed back into foreign currency on departure. Currency exchange through street exchange merchants should be avoided.

ATMs are widely available in Nairobi and Mombasa; these accept debit or credit cards carrying international teller network symbols such as Cirrus, Maestro, MasterCard and Visa. Credit cards are not widely accepted beyond larger facilities in Nairobi, Mombasa and Kisumu. Even in these three cities, it is advisable to carry some cash. However, visitors should leave larger sums of money in a safety deposit box at their hotel.

Cultural Tips

General Tips

- Eye contact is an important way to establish trust. Staring is not considered rude.
- Kenyans are proud of their national products, such as food and local meats, as well as their cultural heritage.
- Address Kenyans formally upon introductions.
- Ask permission before photographing. Do not photograph the military, police, official buildings or embassies. You may be detained.
- Before and after eating a meal, people are expected to wash their hands in a bowl located left of the table.
- Use the right hand or both hands when receiving or giving an item to another person. The use of the left hand alone is considered rude.
- Kenya does not have any strict dress code, but the coastal regions have a significant Muslim population and modest dress is advised, particularly in Mombasa. Women do not wear sleeveless dresses or blouses. Shorts are only worn by children, elderly men and tourists.
- Public displays of affection are considered unacceptable.
- Homosexual activity is illegal. Same-sex couples should exercise discretion, though they are unlikely to be imprisoned.

Business Tips

- Business in Kenya tends to be conducted formally and conservatively.
- Business dress is formal. Lightweight suits are most commonly worn, with a jacket and tie.
- Handshakes are the customary form of greeting upon both business introductions and departures.
- Offices and businesses generally close for at least an hour for lunch.
- Make appointments in advance.
- The pace of business may be slow. Be patient and expect delays.
- Most business is conducted in English and business cards are customarily exchanged.

Businesswomen

While Eastern Africa has a high incidence of sexual assault and rapes, the majority of cases are either domestic or occur in low-income communities, where women face additional vulnerabilities. Nonetheless, female travellers should be alert to the increased risks and adopt sensible security precautions as a routine measure.

- The majority of attacks on lone female travellers occur at night in dark streets, beach areas, unauthorised taxis or in the vicinity of nightlife areas. Remain vigilant in such areas and book taxis through the hotel or a trusted local third party.
- Female travellers are advised to prioritise security concerns when selecting accommodation. Lone females relocating for the medium-to-long term should reside in a secure complex where possible.
- Adopt sensible pedestrian security measures; avoid walking unattended in isolated areas and desist from walking outside of secure locations after dark. When walking, be aware of your surroundings and occasionally check for any signs that you are being followed.
- Avoid giving away personal information to unfamiliar people, including full name, contact details and any address where you might be staying, visiting or working.
- Be particularly alert in restaurants, bars and nightclubs. Never leave a drink unattended or accept drinks from strangers. Some common effects of date rape drugs include dizziness, drowsiness, memory loss – which can be transient or long lasting depending on the drug –, nausea, vomiting, confusion and impaired muscle control. Travellers who suspect they may have been victim of a date rape attack should seek professional medical advice and support immediately.
- For further tips consult the ‘Additional Advice for Women' section of our General Security Advice in our travel security pages.

Tipping

Tipping is not customary in Kenya, however a 10% service charge may be added to the bill in more upmarket restaurants. Otherwise small change in local currency may be offered to taxi drivers, porters and waiters. However, on safari, drivers, guides and cooks often rely heavily on tips, but these are discretionary.

Working Week

- Business hours: 09.00 to 13.00 and 14.00 to 17.00 Monday to Friday; some businesses close on Fridays and Saturdays.
- Banking hours: 09.00-15.00, Monday-Friday.

Phone & Power

Kenya Telecommunications

Emergency Numbers	
Fire	999
Police	999

Dialing Codes	
Country Code	254
IDD Prefix (International Direct Dialing)	00
NDD Prefix (National Direct Dialing)	0

Telephone Information

The telephone system is adequate, though connections can be slow and erratic. International direct dialling and faxing facilities are available from hotels. Cellular network coverage is good in the main cities and much of the south of the country. GSM operators Orange, Safaricom and Airtel have roaming arrangements with the major European networks; visitors can easily obtain a local SIM card and top-up payment cards for these are also readily available. Use of international long-distance calling cards is limited and costs are significantly higher. Users of mobile telephones should not use their phones too conspicuously. Mobile telephone theft from pedestrians is a problem, particularly in Nairobi. If confronted by a thief, as with all other robberies, travellers should hand over the telephone.

The postal service is still unreliable and slow, and goods are frequently stolen from packages. Visitors should use international courier firms such as DHL. DHL has offices in Nairobi (several), Mombasa, Nakuru and other locations. The Kenyan post office, Posta, also offers a domestic and international courier service with online tracking.

Internet connectivity is increasingly widespread. Most business-class hotels have Wi-Fi. Most cities have several internet cafes that often offer business services, such as faxing and photocopying. Mobile data services through all operators are slow but manageable in major urban centres.

Kenya Electricity

Voltage and Frequency

Additional Electrical Information

Voltage: 240 volts
Frequency: 50 Hz

This is the most common plug type used:



Geography & Weather

Weather data provided by weather.com

Climate

Coastal areas are tropical and humid. The lowlands are hot and the highlands are temperate with four seasons (December-March: dry; March-June: wet; June-October: cool; November: wet). The 'long rains' generally occur from April to June and the 'short rains' take place from October to November. Nairobi has a pleasant climate throughout the year, but can get chilly in the evening, so bringing a jacket or sweater is advisable. Average temperature in Nairobi is around 21°C (70°F) and in Mombasa around 26°C (80°F).

GEOGRAPHY

Kenya is located in East Africa, with the equator running across the centre of the country. It is bordered by Ethiopia and South Sudan to the north, Somalia and the Indian Ocean to the east, Uganda to the west and Tanzania to the south. The country comprises 47 counties, including the capital, Nairobi. Mombasa, the second largest city, is the country's main seaport. Kisumu is another major port, located on Lake Victoria.

Kenyan topography changes as one travels west from the coast. The coastal regions in the east are fertile and bordered with coral reefs and islands on the ocean side. The coastal regions give way to gradually rising coastal plains that are largely dry and covered with savannah and thorn bush. The plains merge into the high plateau region, also known as the Kenyan highlands. This region features peaks such as Mount Kenya, Mount Elgon and the Aberdare Range, and houses the majority of the country's population and economic centres. The north-western region of Kenya is arid and semi-desert; the principal rivers are the Tana, the Athi, and the Ewaso Ngiro.

Embassies & Consulates

Embassies

Argentina Embassy

Kitisuru Tate Close 3.3.E; Nairobi

Kenya
Telephone: +254 20 4183119

Fascimilie: +254 20 4183054

Email: ekeny@mrecic.gov.ar

website: ekeny.cancilleria.gov.ar

Australia High Commission

Nairobi
Riverside Drive (400 metres off Chiromo Road); Nairobi

Nairobi
Kenya
Telephone: +254 20 4277100

Fascimilie: +254 20 4277139

Email: australian.hc.kenya@dfat.gov.au

website: http://www.kenya.embassy.gov.au/nair/home.html

Belgium Embassy

Nairobi
Limuru Road, Muthaïga; Nairobi

Nairobi 00100
Kenya
Telephone: +254 207122011

Fascimilie: +254 207123050

Email: Nairobi@diplobel.fed.be

website: http://www.diplomatie.be/nairobi/

Brazil Embassy

121 UN Crescent Road, UN Close; Nairobi

Kenya
Telephone: (+254) 20 712-5766

Email: nairobi@itamaraty.gov.br

website: nairobi.itamaraty.gov.br

Canada High Commission

Nairobi
Limuru Road, Gigiri; Nairobi

Nairobi
Kenya
Telephone: +254 20 3663000

Fascimilie: +254 20 3663900

Email: nrobi@international.gc.ca

website: http://www.canadainternational.gc.ca/kenya/

China Embassy

Nairobi
Woodlands Rd.; Nairobi

Nairobi
Kenya
Telephone: +254 20 2726851

Fascimilie: +254 20 2726402/2711

Email: chinaemb_ke@mfa.gov.cn

website: http://ke.china-embassy.org/eng/

Denmark Embassy

13 Runda Drive, Runda; Nairobi

Kenya
Telephone: +254 20 4253000

Fascimilie: +254 20 4253299

Email: nboamb@um.dk

website: www.kenya.um.dk

Finland Embassy

Nairobi
Eden Square, Block 3, 6th Floor, Greenway Rd off Westlands Rd; Nairobi

Nairobi
Kenya
Telephone: +254 20 3750721

Fascimilie: +254 20 3750714

Email: sanomat.nai@formin.fi

website: http://www.finland.or.ke

France Embassy

Nairobi
9th Floor, Barclays Plaza, Loita Street; Nairobi

Nairobi
Kenya
Telephone: +254 20 2778000

Fascimilie: +254 20 2778180

Email: ambafrance.nairobi@diplomatie.gouv.fr

website: http://www.ambafrance-ke.org/-French-embassy-in-Nairobi-

Germany Embassy

Nairobi
Riverside Drive 113; Nairobi

Nairobi
Kenya
Telephone: +254 20 4262100

Fascimilie: +254 20 4262129

Email: info@nairobi.diplo.de

website: http://www.nairobi.diplo.de/

India Embassy

Jeevan Bharati House, Harambee Avenue; Nairobi

Kenya
Telephone: +254 20 222566

Fascimilie: + 254 20 316242

Email: cons.nairobi@mea.gov.in

website: www.hcinairobi.co.ke/index.php

Indonesia Embassy

Menengai Road, Upper Hill; Nairobi

Kenya
Telephone: +254 20 2714196

Fascimilie: +254 20 2713475

Email: http://www.indonesia.or.ke

website: http://www.indonesia.or.ke

Italy Embassy

Nairobi
International House, 9th floor, Mama Ngina Street; Nairobi

Nairobi
Kenya
Telephone: +254 20 2247696

Fascimilie: +254 20 2247086

Email: ambasciata.nairobi@esteri.it

website: http://www.ambnairobi.esteri.it/Ambasciata_Nairobi

Japan Embassy

Nairobi
Mara Road, Upper Hill; Nairobi

Nairobi
Kenya
Telephone: +254 20 2898000

Fascimilie: +254 20 2898531

Email: jinfocul@nb.mofa.go.jp

website: http://www.ke.emb-japan.go.jp/

Mexico Embassy

60 Kibagare Way, Loresho

Kenya
Telephone: +254 700 751849

Email: embkenia@sre.gob.mx

website: http://http://www.sre.gob.mx/kenia

Netherlands Embassy

Nairobi
Riverside Lane, off Riverside Drive; Nairobi

Nairobi
Kenya
Telephone: +254 20 4288000

Fascimilie: +254 20 4288264

Email: nai@minbuza.nl

website: http://kenia.nlembassy.org/

Norway Embassy

58 Red Hill Road (junction Limuru Road), Gigiri; Nairobi

Kenya
Telephone: +254 (0) 20 425 1000

Email: emb.nairobi@mfa.no

website: http://www.norway.or.ke/

Russia Embassy

P.O. Box 30049, Lenana Road; Nairobi

Kenya
Telephone: +254 20 2728700

Fascimilie: +254 20 2721888

Email: russemb@swiftkenya.com

website: http://russianembassy.ru/en/embassies/kenya

Saudi Arabia Embassy

Muthaigh Road; Nairobi

Kenya
Telephone: +254 20 4062781

Fascimilie: +254 20 4045262

Email: keemb@Mofa.Gov.Sa

website: http://embassies.mofa.gov.sa/sites/kenya/en/pages/default.aspx

South Africa High Commission

Nairobi
3rd Floor Roshanmaer Place, Lenana Road; Nairobi

Nairobi
Kenya
Telephone: +254 20 2827100

Fascimilie: +254 20 282720156

Email: sahc@africaonline.co.ke

South Korea Embassy

1st & 2nd Floor, Misha Tower, Westlands Road; Nairobi

Kenya
Telephone: +254 20 3615000

Fascimilie: +254 20 3741337

Email: emb-ke@mofa.go.kr

website: http://ken.mofa.go.kr/english/af/ken/main/index.jsp

Spain Embassy

Nairobi
C.B.A. Building, 3rd floor Mara & Ragati Road, Upper Hill; Nairobi

Nairobi
Kenya
Telephone: +254 20 2720222

Fascimilie: +254 20 2720226

Email: emb.nairobi@maec.es

website: http://www.exteriores.gob.es/embajadas/nairobi/es/Paginas/inicio.aspx

Sweden Embassy

Nairobi
United Nations Crescent, Gigiri; Nairobi

Nairobi
Kenya
Telephone: +254 20 4234000

Fascimilie: +254 20 4234339

Email: embassy.nairobi@gov.se

website: http://www.swedenabroad.com/en-GB/Embassies/Nairobi/

Switzerland Embassy

Nairobi
General Mathenge Drive 89, Spring Valley, Westlands; Nairobi

Nairobi
Kenya
Telephone: +254 20 2673282

Fascimilie: +254 20 2673535

Email: nai.vertretung@eda.admin.ch

website: http://www.eda.admin.ch/nairobi

Turkey Embassy

30 Gigiri Road; Nairobi

Kenya
Telephone: +254 20 7121444

Fascimilie: +254 20 7121443

Email: nairobi@ekonomi.gov.tr

website: www.musavirlikler.gov.tr

United Kingdom Embassy

Nairobi
Upper Hill Road; Nairobi

Nairobi
Kenya
Telephone: +254 20 2844000

Fascimilie: +254 20 2844088

Email: Nairobi.Enquiries@fco.gov.uk

website: http://ukinkenya.fco.gov.uk

United States Embassy

Nairobi
United Nations Avenue, Village Market; Nairobi

Nairobi
Kenya
Telephone: +254 20 3636000

Fascimilie: +254 20 3636501

Email: ircnairobi@state.gov

website: http://nairobi.usembassy.gov/

Calendar

2017

10 Oct Moi Day

20 Oct Kenyatta Forces Day

12 Dec Jamhuri/Independence Day

25 Dec Christmas Day
In some countries, if this holiday falls on a Saturday or Sunday, a public holiday is declared for the following Monday.

26 Dec Boxing Day
In many countries, if this holiday falls on a Saturday or Sunday, a public holiday is observed on the following Monday or Tuesday respectively.

2018

01 Jan New Year's Day
In many countries, if this holiday falls on a Saturday or Sunday, a public holiday is declared for the following Monday.

01 May Workers' Day/Labour Day/May Day/Spring Day
Student/labour demonstrations. If the holiday falls on a rest day, it may be observed on the next working day.

01 Jun Madaraka Day
Rallies on this day are likely to draw large crowds and cause travel disruption.

Nairobi

CITY RISK RATING
Travel
H HIGH TRAVEL RISK

CITY SECURITY OVERVIEW

Nairobi is the capital of Kenya. Crime rates remain high with petty and violent crime posing the main risk to visitors. Most criminal incidents are opportunistic snatch–and-grab thefts aimed as much at native Kenyans as at foreigners, who are targeted often due to their perceived wealth. The presence of suspected Islamist extremists in the city means there is a risk of terrorist attacks against perceived Western targets.

ORIENTATION

Most offices, government buildings and hotels are located in the city centre near Kenyatta Avenue and City Hall Way. The majority of expatriates live in the suburbs of Gigiri, Karen, Kilimani, Loresho and Westlands, which are located in the west and north-west of the city centre.

Nairobi

CRIME

Theft and armed robbery pose the greatest risk to foreign visitors; such risks in the city centre increase significantly north-east of Tom Mboya Street. Most incidents are opportunistic and travellers can significantly reduce the risk by driving in a locked vehicle wherever possible, exercising high levels of situational awareness in public and keeping valuables hidden, particularly in and around crime hotspots such as the Globe Cinema Roundabout and the Ring Road around Race Course Road. Visitors should also take precautions against pickpocketing in crowded areas such as the Central Market and Kenyatta Avenue.

Beyond theft and armed robberies, common crimes impacting foreigners – particularly longer-term visitors and expatriates – are residential break-ins and serious vehicle-related crimes, such as carjackings. Most expats live in affluent areas such as the suburbs of Gigiri, Kilimani, Loresho and Westlands, which are located west and north-west of the city centre and Hardy and Karen located in the south-west of the city. However, criminals are attracted to these areas due to the perceived wealth of residents. Most break-ins are reported between 21.00 and 06.00 (local time) and at residences located close to major roads. Criminals in some instances access residences with the benefit of insider knowledge or aided by rogue security guards, domestic workers, gardeners or other staff. Methods of entry include breaking through walls, cutting or jumping over fences or taking residents hostage at the gates; criminals also occasionally pose as members of the security forces or private security guards to gain entry.

Carjacking rates increase significantly after dark; attackers will usually approach the vehicle from behind while it is stationary at junctions, traffic lights and residential gates. One particular criminal tactic to force vehicles to stop involves throwing eggs at the driver's windscreen. If this happens, drivers should not stop the car or attempt to clear the windscreen with the wipers and/or washer fluid as this will further impair their view.

TERRORISM

Due to Nairobi's significance as East Africa's foremost commercial city, as well as the country's ongoing operations against transnational and domestic terrorist groups, the city remains susceptible to a range of terrorist threats. On 21 September 2013, members of the Somalia-based Islamist al-Shabab militant group staged an armed raid and took several people hostage at the affluent Westgate shopping centre; more than 65 people were killed and 170 injured in the attack. The incident is the most serious terrorist attack to take place since the 1998 bombing of the US embassy in Nairobi in which 213 people were killed.

Although al-Shabab still poses the most serious Islamist extremist threat in Nairobi, the Islamist extremist group Islamic State (IS) in 2016 articulated a presence in the city. Security guards at the US embassy in October 2016 fatally shot an assailant after he stabbed a General Service Unit (GSU) officer guarding one of the entrances. IS subsequently claimed that a supporter of the group was responsible for the attack. There have also been sporadic reports regarding the arrests of IS sympathisers in Nairobi in 2016.

With the exception of the Westgate raid, militant attacks in the city have been historically confined to low-income areas and have had a low and localised impact. Areas most commonly targeted include Dandora, South C, Eastleigh, and other industrial districts, which offer operational sanctuaries to militants due to their pervasive lawlessness, high population density and limited census records, which allow militants to maintain a low profile and stay undetected by the authorities. Furthermore, the presence of domestic Islamist sympathisers in such areas facilitates extremist recruitment, while the proliferation of arms ensures that weaponry is easily available. While these sorts of attacks pose a very low risk to business travellers, the Westgate incident is indicative of the city's latent vulnerability to international Islamist terrorism.

SOCIAL UNREST

Social unrest in the capital most commonly stems from the grievances of low-income communities or volatile occupational groups, including public transport workers, street hawkers and students; these demonstrations are usually spontaneous and can quickly degenerate into localised rioting. The security forces are liable to use forcible dispersal methods on unruly crowds, even in crowded central areas, thereby posing significant incidental risks to travelers.

Politically motivated violence has previously erupted in the run up to and during election periods, and indirectly impacted foreign business travel in the city. A number of violent demonstrations ocurred in April-May 2016 as part of CORD's country-wide protest movement against the perceived corruption of the Independent Electoral and Boundaries Commission (IEBC). The protests affected parts of the CBD, prompting significant traffic disruption.

Social unrest can also occur in low-income neighbourhoods as a result of ethnic or community disputes or in response to specific incidents of crime or upward trends.

TROUBLE SPOTS

Densely-populated areas such as Eastleigh, Kaloleni, Kariobangi, Kariorkor, Kawangware, Kibera, South C, Mathare and Pumwani are worst affected by crime, though crime rates are also high in wealthy districts such as Karen, Kitisuru, Langata and Muthaiga. The industrial estate and areas to the east of Tom Mboya street are also prone to high crime levels. Opportunistic crime hot spots include the Globe Cinema roundabout and the Ring road around Race Course road.

Formal residential areas such as Kayole, Jericho, Huruma, South B and parts of Westlands are also not immune from crime, while Githurai Kimbo, an upcoming estate situated some 12 miles (20km) north of Nairobi's central business district (CBD) is also a prominent trouble spot.

Visitors risk being mugged or attacked on bridges across the Nairobi River, railway bridges, Juja road, streets between the general post office and the Serena Hotel (including Uhuru roundabout), and Uhuru Park. Other crime hotspots include the university area, the National Museum, markets, public toilets and parks.

It is inadvisable to walk anywhere in Nairobi after dark. Makaburini (near Nyayo National Stadium), the Globe Cinema roundabout and the area around Central Park (opposite All Saints Cathedral) are known high-risk areas for rape.

SEEKING HELP

The police are corrupt and underpaid. Although they generally treat visitors well, particularly Westerners, they sometimes harass black travellers, whom they will treat as Kenyan unless otherwise proven. Visitors should carry identification at all times. Officers frequently stop vehicles (particularly hire cars) on flimsy pretexts before levying instant fines. Police officers have reportedly been involved in carjacking incidents.

EMERGENCY NUMBERS

Fire: 999
Police: 999

Ambulance services are not recommended. Contact **International SOS** for help with your medical situation.

Nairobi

PORT OF ENTRY

Airport code: NBO

Jomo Kenyatta International Airport is located approximately ten miles (17km) south-east of the city centre. Terminals 1A, 1B, 1C and 1E cater to international flights, while domestic flights operate from 1D. Travellers should arrive at least three hours prior to complete security formalities.

Visa-on-arrival is available; passengers should keep the required cash in the correct denomination to avoid any difficulty. Some connecting flights, mostly domestic, are operated from Nairobi's smaller Wilson Airport (WIL), which is located 13 miles (20km) north-west of Jomo Kenyatta. Theft of and from luggage is common; visitors should carry any valuable items in their hand luggage and should not leave bags unattended.

Counter-terrorism security measures were increased following the September 2001 terrorist attacks in the US and again in 2003 following further intelligence warnings of terrorist threats. Despite this, airport security levels remain below those in more developed countries. The airport is currently undergoing a modernisation and expansion project to bring it up to Federal Aviation Administration (FAA) standards.

TO CITY CENTRE

Wherever possible, travellers should pre-arrange transfers from the airport with their hotel, their local colleagues or their host company, as there have been reported incidents of foreigners being targeted in carjackings, kidnapping and robberies. Most major business-class hotels maintain desks at Nairobi airport offering shuttle services into the city during peak arrival hours; most major hotels also allow reputable taxi companies to use the stands outside their lobbies, from which a return trip to the airport can be organised. If these options are not available, travellers should pre-arrange a fare with an official taxi from the stand inside the terminal. State-owned Kenatco taxis are safer and more reliable than private taxis; they have their office in the terminal. Travellers should not get into an unregistered taxi waiting outside the airport, especially one that is already carrying a passenger.

WALKING

The city centre is compact and can easily be covered on foot during the daytime. Visitors should avoid walking in the city at night. In affluent suburbs of western Nairobi, daytime walking should be undertaken with caution. Travel in groups, and along major roads rather than side streets, is recommended.

CAR HIRE

Car hire is available, but should be avoided unless visitors are familiar with Kenyan roads: driving standards are appalling; drunken and dangerous driving is common. Many drivers are undisciplined, untrained and drive unroadworthy vehicles. Drivers should complete their journeys before dark where possible: driving is particularly hazardous at night, when some vehicles do not use headlights and drivers may be drunk. The risk of armed robbery is also higher after dark. Visitors are advised to hire a car and a driver which can be arranged through a hotel. Traffic drives on the left.

Carjacking is a serious problem in Nairobi. Thieves favour four-wheel drive (4WD) vehicles: avoid hiring a luxury or overtly attractive model due to the greater risk from carjacking. Gunmen usually force victims out of their car or abandon them in a remote area. If involved in a carjacking, visitors are advised not to resist. There have also been reports of thieves snatching jewellery and other valuables from vehicles stopped at traffic lights or in heavy traffic. Visitors should close car windows and lock doors at all times.

PUBLIC TRANSPORT

Visitors should not use public transport. Shared minibus taxis and buses (matatus) are generally unsafe and are prone to extreme overcrowding. Likewise, motorcycle taxis (boda-bodas) should also be avoided for safety reasons.

TAXIS

Taxis are available at major hotels and large office blocks, but should not be hailed from the street. Taxis are not usually shared. State-owned Kenatco taxis (which have the firm's logo stencilled on their windows) are safer and more reliable than private taxis, albeit more expensive. Visitors should agree the fare in advance, as drivers may overcharge those who appear unfamiliar with local distances and prices.

Mobile-based car share apps, such as Uber, are available. The suitability of the service will depend on a traveller's profile. If using a ride share service, ensure that there is not an existing taxi rank in the vicinity of the pick-up or drop-off location and keep a low profile when getting into the vehicle. Travellers should contact an Assistance Centre for an assessment on their travel arrangements.

Nairobi

High Commission of Australia

Riverside Drive (400 metres off Chiromo Road)
Nairobi
Kenya

Phone: +254 20 4277100
Fax: +254 20 4277139
Email: australian.hc.kenya@dfat.gov.au
Website: http://www.kenya.embassy.gov.au/nair/home.html

Embassy of Belgium

Limuru Road, Muthaïga
Nairobi00100
Kenya

Phone: +254 207122011
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Third phone: +254 708036674
Fax: +254 207123050
Email: Nairobi@diplobel.fed.be
Website: http://www.diplomatie.be/nairobi/

High Commission of Canada

Limuru Road, Gigiri
Nairobi
Kenya

Phone: +254 20 3663000
Fax: +254 20 3663900
Email: nrobi@international.gc.ca
Website: http://www.canadainternational.gc.ca/kenya/

Embassy of China

Woodlands Rd.
Nairobi
Kenya

Phone: +254 20 2726851
Second phone: +254 717070214
Fax: +254 20 2726402/2711
Email: chinaemb_ke@mfa.gov.cn
Website: http://ke.china-embassy.org/eng/

Embassy of Finland

Eden Square, Block 3, 6th Floor, Greenway Rd off Westlands Rd
Nairobi
Kenya

Phone: +254 20 3750721
Second phone: +254 20 3750724
Fax: +254 20 3750714
Email: sanomat.nai@formin.fi
Website: http://www.finland.or.ke

Embassy of France

9th Floor, Barclays Plaza, Loita Street
Nairobi
Kenya

Phone: +254 20 2778000
Fax: +254 20 2778180
Email: ambafrance.nairobi@diplomatie.gouv.fr
Website: http://www.ambafrance-ke.org/-French-embassy-in-Nairobi-

Embassy of Germany

Riverside Drive 113
Nairobi
Kenya

Phone: +254 20 4262100
Second phone: +254 20 3501376
Third phone: +254 20 2605601
Fax: +254 20 4262129
Email: info@nairobi.diplo.de
Website: http://www.nairobi.diplo.de/

Embassy of Italy

International House, 9th floor, Mama Ngina Street
Nairobi
Kenya

Phone: +254 20 2247696
Second phone: +254 20 2247750
Third phone: +254 20 2247755
Fax: +254 20 2247086
Email: ambasciata.nairobi@esteri.it
Website: http://www.ambnairobi.esteri.it/Ambasciata_Nairobi

Embassy of Japan

Mara Road, Upper Hill
Nairobi
Kenya

Phone: +254 20 2898000
Fax: +254 20 2898531
Email: jinfocul@nb.mofa.go.jp
Website: http://www.ke.emb-japan.go.jp/

Embassy of Netherlands

Riverside Lane, off Riverside Drive
Nairobi
Kenya

Phone: +254 20 4288000
Second phone: +254 0 727594727
Fax: +254 20 4288264
Email: nai@minbuza.nl
Website: http://kenia.nlembassy.org/

High Commission of South Africa

3rd Floor Roshanmaer Place, Lenana Road
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Kenya

Phone: +254 20 2827100
Fax: +254 20 282720156
Email: sahc@africaonline.co.ke

Embassy of Spain

C.B.A. Building, 3rd floor Mara & Ragati Road, Upper Hill
Nairobi
Kenya

Phone: +254 20 2720222
Second phone: +254 20 2720223
Third phone: +254 20 2720224
Fax: +254 20 2720226

Email: emb.nairobi@maec.es
Website: http://www.exteriores.gob.es/embajadas/nairobi/es/Paginas/inicio.aspx

Embassy of Sweden

United Nations Crescent, Gigiri
Nairobi
Kenya

Phone: +254 20 4234000
Second phone: +254 726 089300
Fax: +254 20 4234339
Email: embassy.nairobi@gov.se
Website: http://www.swedenabroad.com/en-GB/Embassies/Nairobi/

Embassy of Switzerland

General Mathenge Drive 89, Spring Valley, Westlands
Nairobi
Kenya

Phone: +254 20 2673282
Second phone: +254 708707687
Fax: +254 20 2673535
Email: nai.vertretung@eda.admin.ch
Website: http://www.eda.admin.ch/nairobi

Embassy of United Kingdom

Upper Hill Road
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Kenya

Phone: +254 20 2844000
Second phone: +254 20 2873000
Fax: +254 20 2844088
Email: Nairobi.Enquiries@fco.gov.uk
Website: http://ukinkenya.fco.gov.uk

Embassy of United States

United Nations Avenue, Village Market
Nairobi
Kenya

Phone: +254 20 3636000
Fax: +254 20 3636501
Email: ircnairobi@state.gov
Website: http://nairobi.usembassy.gov/

Nairobi

2017

10 Oct Moi Day

20 Oct Kenyatta Forces Day

12 Dec Jamhuri/Independence Day

25 Dec Christmas Day
In some countries, if this holiday falls on a Saturday or Sunday, a public holiday is declared for the following Monday.

26 Dec Boxing Day
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01 May Workers' Day/Labour Day/May Day/Spring Day
Student/labour demonstrations. If the holiday falls on a rest day, it may be observed on the next working day.

01 Jun Madaraka Day
Rallies on this day are likely to draw large crowds and cause travel disruption.

Nairobi

EXTERNAL LINK

City map of Nairobi (Google Maps)

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